

Vacuum Erection Device (VED)

Patient Information · A device without medicine that draws blood in to make an erection

WARWIKI

A vacuum erection device (VED), or “penis pump,” makes an erection without medicine. Gentle suction **pulls blood into the penis**. A soft ring at the base then holds the blood in. It is used to treat erection problems and, after prostate surgery, to help keep the penis healthy.

How It Works

You place a plastic tube over the penis and pump out the air. The suction pulls blood in and makes an erection. You then slide a **tension ring** onto the base of the penis to hold the blood in, and take off the tube.

Who It Is For

- Men who want an option **without medicine**, or who cannot take erection pills
- Men who are **recovering after prostate surgery**. Using the pump without the ring helps keep the penis healthy.
- It can be used together with erection pills

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

8 in 10

men can have sex with it

1 in 4

get some bruising or small red spots on the penis

5–6 in 10

are still using it after 2 years

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

Check With Your Team First If You

- Take a **blood thinner** or have a bleeding problem
- Have **sickle cell disease**, or have had erections in the past that would not go down (priapism)
- Are getting collagenase (Xiaflex) shots for Peyronie's disease

Learn the Terms

VED

Vacuum erection device. A pump that makes an erection with suction.

Cylinder

The plastic tube placed over the penis.

Tension ring

The soft ring placed at the base of the penis to hold the erection.

Vacuum limiter

A safety part that stops the suction from getting too strong.

Penile rehabilitation

Keeping the penis healthy after surgery, for example after prostate surgery.

Erectile dysfunction (ED)

Trouble getting or keeping an erection firm enough for sex.

The one timing rule: Never leave the tension ring on for **more than 30 minutes**. Leaving it on too long cuts off blood flow and can injure the penis. Take the ring off right after sex, and never fall asleep with it on.

How to Use It

- 1 Put water-based lubricant on the base of the penis. Place the tube snugly against your body.
- 2 Pump slowly until you have an erection. Stop if it hurts.
- 3 Slide the **tension ring** onto the base. Release the suction and take off the tube.
- 4 **Take the ring off within 30 minutes**, and right after sex.

Use a medical device with a **vacuum limiter**. For recovery after surgery, your team may have you pump **without** the ring on a set schedule.

Good to Know

- The erection may feel **cool**, and it may pivot at the base. This is normal.
- The ring can trap semen until you take it off. This is harmless.
- Numbness or mild discomfort can happen. It takes some practice to get good results.

Call the office that is treating you if you have:

- Bruising, swelling or numbness that does not go away
- A sore or break in the skin of the penis

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot get the ring off
- The penis stays dark, cold or very painful after the ring is off
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. A VED makes an erection with suction and holds it with a ring. No medicine is needed.
2. **Never leave the ring on for more than 30 minutes**, and never sleep with it on.
3. Check with your team first if you take a blood thinner or have sickle cell disease.